TASK 4: SUSPENSION COMPONENT REPLACEMENT AND ALIGNMENT PREPARATION

Autocare Technician Level 2 | Block 5 | v2.1

TIME	EVIDENCE	PROGRAMME POINT
60 minutes	**Practical | Knowledge | Documentation**	**Weeks 41-50**

Your task

A vehicle has been reported with a worn suspension component. You must inspect the component, remove/refit the part as instructed, record torque data and identify whether alignment or further checks are required.

What you must do

1. Prepare the vehicle and raise/support it safely where required.
2. Inspect the relevant suspension component and confirm the fault.
3. Remove and refit the component instructed by the assessor/workplace mentor.
4. Record correct torque settings and any alignment implications.
5. Reinstate the vehicle/workstation and explain recommendations.

What good evidence looks like

SAFE SETUP
Suitable PPE, a prepared work area and controlled vehicle or equipment.

CORRECT METHOD
A logical sequence using the relevant procedure and technical information.

ACCURATE EVIDENCE
Actual readings, findings and actions recorded clearly and precisely.

SOUND DECISIONS
Appropriate recommendations, referral or authorisation supported by evidence.

You will need

- Light vehicle or suspension rig
- Replacement component as required
- Manufacturer technical information
- Torque wrench and general tools
- PPE and Apprentice Assessment Record

SOW ALIGNMENT

Block 5 - Diagnostic Thinking and Complex Repairs
Duties: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 KSB evidence focus: K10-K18, S6-S14, B1, B2
Task reference: Block_5_Task_4_Suspension_Component_Replacement

Apprentice, location and vehicle details

Apprentice name

Date

TASK COMPLETED AT

○ **APPRENTICE'S WORKPLACE**

○ **TRAINING CENTRE**

Vehicle make

Model

Registration

Mileage

Engine size / type

VIN / chassis number

Measurements and technical checks

Component replaced		Suspension type	
Top mounting torque		Bottom mounting torque	
Wheel torque setting		Alignment required yes/no	
Visible tyre wear		Post-repair check result	

Special tools, equipment or calibration requirements

Task evidence

PPE and precautions used

Safety-critical findings and immediate action

Work completed, findings and recommendations

Knowledge check

1. What safety precautions apply when working with suspension components?

2. What defects can be found on ball joints, bushes or dampers?

Knowledge check - continued

3. (a) How can a worn suspension component affect handling? (b) Why may alignment be required after replacement?

4. Why must torque settings be recorded?

5. (a) How would you explain the repair to a customer? (b) What quality checks are needed before releasing the vehicle?

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation

- ☐ Inspect suspension components using safe working practices.
- ☐ Remove and refit a suspension component as instructed.
- ☐ Record manufacturer torque settings and relevant measurements.
- ☐ Identify how the component affects handling and tyre wear.
- ☐ Explain alignment and customer recommendation requirements.

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation notes

Decision and feedback

Decision - select one

○ **PASS** ○ **REFER**

Evidence reference

Feedback and action required

Sign-off

Signatures confirm that this is the apprentice's own work and that the evidence and decision are accurate.

Apprentice name

Assessor/Workplace Mentor name

PIN (if applicable)

Apprentice signature

Assessor/Workplace Mentor signature

Date